MBAI 5410: Digital Transformation

Project Plan

Sorbara

A Gafoor, K Snow, A Balkarran, M Kayode
3-24-2026

Table of Contents

Introduction

Sorbara Group has experienced significant growth over the past 80 years as an integrated real estate and development organization. This growth has led to fragmented data and reporting inconsistencies across various systems. To address these issues and facilitate data-driven decision-making, Sorbara will implement Microsoft Fabric as its unified data analytics platform. This initiative aims to centralize data management, improve accessibility, and accelerate reporting leading to increased efficiency and realized cost savings.

The following outlines the project plan necessary for implementing Microsoft Fabric successfully.

Implementation Phasing & Milestones

Phase 1 – Planning & Analysis (Month 1)

The first phase of the project focuses on planning and feasibility analysis to consider if there is enough time, resources and knowledge to implement the project (Coster, et al., 2023). Requirements will also be analyzed to ensure that Microsoft Fabric is compatible with Sorbara's existing systems.

Key Milestones	Dependencies
● Project Kickoff Meeting ● Requirements documentation completed ● Data source inventory completed ● Technical architecture defined ● Data governance and security requirements defined	● IT team collaboration ● Access to internal systems ● Stakeholder input

Phase 2 – System Design & Development (Months 2 & 3)

During this phase, the project team will take the business requirements from Phase 1 and translate them into technical requirements to ensure that the incoming system is scalable, and data can be integrated across the system.

Key Milestones	Dependencies
● Data architecture finalized ● Data pipelines built ● Role-based security designed ● Initial canned reports/dashboards created ● Data governance and security requirements defined	● Completed requirements ● Technical configuration of Microsoft Fabric ● Vendor support

Phase 3 – Integration & Testing (Month 4)

This is the most difficult phase of the project (Coster, et al., 2023). Microsoft Fabric will be integrated with the existing systems to ensure data can be shared across Sorbara's multiple departments and companies.

Key Milestones	Dependencies
• Successful system integration • Pilot implementation with Accounting Department to validate data accuracy, reporting functionality and user experience prior to full organizational deployment • User acceptance testing (UAT) is completed	• Stable data pipelines • Successful and accurate data migration • User support/participation in testing

Commented [1]: @kylie.snow@ontariotechu.net added something small.
Assigned to kylie.snow@ontariotechu.net

Phase 4 – Deployment & Organizational Rollout (Month 5 & 6)

This phase focuses on operationalizing the platform and ensuring employees can effectively use it so that it can become embedded into daily operations across Sorbara's many departments and companies.

Key Milestones	Dependencies
• Platform deployed organization-wide • Initial canned reports and dashboards are made available • Access and security controls are configured • User Training completed	• Successful testing • Users are ready to train • Security approval

Phase 5 – Optimization and Continuous Improvement (Ongoing)

This phase allows for continuous feedback from users to enhance reporting capabilities over time.

Key Milestones
• System performance improved • Analytics features expanded • User adoption increased

Cross-Phase Dependencies

Several cross-phase dependencies have been identified below highlighting the importance of accuracy during the earlier phases and continuous stakeholder involvement throughout the project life cycle.

- Gaps or ill-defined requirements in Phase 1 may lead to rework during system design and deployment in Phase 2.
- Incomplete data cleaning and validation in earlier phases may reduce the effectiveness of the pilot implementation (Phase 3)
- Delays in vendor support during system configuration and integration (Phases 2 & 3) may impact timelines.
- Lack of stakeholder engagement during testing and pilot could impact adoption during organizational rollout (Phase 4)

Integration & Technical Approach

System Integration Requirements:

Fabric requires native integration with existing Microsoft 365 workflows and open-ecosystem connectivity to import data in any format. It utilizes a single resource pool to power all workloads, from data engineering to business intelligence.

Data Migration Considerations:

The strategy prioritizes data virtualization over physical migration. By using OneLake shortcuts, the organization works from a single copy of data across different engines, drastically reducing the time spent on data preparation

Testing Strategy:

The free trial serves as the primary sandbox environment for initial feature testing. We will then move into a pilot phase focusing on "Problem Child" projects (high-growth potential) before initiating User Acceptance Testing (UAT) to ensure the solution meets specific "business utility" needs.

Commented [2]: @kylie.snow@ontariotechu.net @aneesa.balkarran@ontariotechu.net are we still going through with the free trial since we already selected the vendor

Commented [3R2]: @Afeena, the free trial can be used as a Pilot before rolling out to the full organization. Accounting can use the free trial to determine the capacity needed.

Vendor Involvement:

We will engage Microsoft sales specialists for capacity planning and leverage the partner network for specialized industry [workloads -> can we use the word tasks instead of workloads]. Ongoing updates will be sourced from the Microsoft Fabric Blog and Technical Updates.

Security/Compliance Considerations:

Universal governance will be managed through Microsoft Purview, while built-in disaster recovery tools and shared resilience will ensure the stability of mission-critical infrastructure.

Training & Adoption Strategy

The training and adoption strategy employed will provide the required training and drive the adoption of the new technology across the organization. It will also provide a smooth and easy transition into Microsoft Fabric.

Stakeholder groups impacted

Finance and Accounting: The finance and accounting team is a key stakeholder for this implementation and will mostly be impacted. Microsoft Fabric will provide automated reporting for their reports which are currently maintained manually outside the system.

Commented [4]: @mofoluwasho.kayode@ontariotechu.net is it "a" or "the"

Commercial, Residential, and Land development teams: The Commercial, Residential, and Land development teams will equally be impacted by this implementation. Dashboards and reports will be used to get clear insights into property management, tenant lifecycles, and development projects.

Business Solutions: The business solutions team is the technology enabler for the Microsoft Fabric implementation and will be required to set up the system, manage it, and control data access.

Corporate Records: Corporate records will be responsible for data control and oversee how reports are stored, accessed, and audited.

Commented [5]: @mofoluwasho.kayode@ontariotechu.net can we please discuss this one?
Assigned to mofoluwasho.kayode@ontariotechu.net

HR: The HR team will provide training coordination and onboarding support for the implementation.

The Executive Team and Advisory Board: The Executive Team and Advisory Board are the main decision makers and will make use of the reports and dashboards generated to make informed decisions.

Training methods

Super Users: Super users in various teams will be identified and given training on Microsoft Fabric. These super users will then be the go-to-persons for their teams.

Hands-on Workshops: Short and practical sessions will be held for various teams with team specific training.

E-learning modules and quick guides: A library of short videos and pdf guides will be created which staff can easily refer to for guidance on how to carry out various simple tasks.

Communication strategy

Company-wide communication will be maintained before, during and after the implementation to ensure staff are fully carried along and understand the reason for the change and how it helps and impacts them. Weekly updates will be shared by leadership on the implementation status and progress made. These communication and updates will be in the form of emails and presentations. Regular feedback will also be gotten from staff. This feedback will be promptly reviewed and concerns addressed.

Commented [6]: @mofoluwasho.kayode@ontariotechu.net can we say "equipped" or "sustain"

Ongoing support structure

Help Desk: There will be a main help desk to provide support for issues experienced by staff. This will be in the form of tickets and emails.

Central Knowledge Base: This will be a digital storage that will house training materials, guides and FAQs that staff can always have access to.

Super Users: Super users within each team will also provide staff in those teams with first level support.

Regular Check-ins: Regular check-ins will be done with the teams to get feedback and review progress. Improvements will be made following feedback and issues addressed.

Risk and Mitigation Overview

This Risk and Mitigation Overview identifies the primary challenges that could impact the project's timeline, data integrity, and user acceptance. By proactively categorizing risks- ranging from technical integration to organizational adoption- we established a robust framework to safeguard the project's success.

Risk Description	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation Strategy
Scope Creep	Medium	High	• Clearly define what is IN scope and what is OUT of scope • Strict adherence to IN Scope requirements • Move all new requests to another project phase
Delayed migration due to poor data quality	Medium	High	• Data analysis • Clean and transform data • Pre-migration data validation
Low user adoption	Medium	High	• Training programs for running/creating reports and using dashboards

			• Implementation of parallel system approach • Report verification (cross system verification)
System Integration failures (**all** datasources)	Low	High	• Early vendor engagement with IT • Gather all smaller data stores and centralize for ingestion
Internal Data Breach & Governance during rollout	Low	High	• Examine current access controls across systems and files • Audit of access controls of implemented system • Create and enforce policies for access control
Delay in vendor support	Low	Medium	• Project roadmap with milestones • Active communication with vendor

Success Metrics & Performance Monitoring

To ensure the proposed reporting system delivers measurable value, we established a framework that tracks performance across three critical dimensions: operational efficiency, user adoption, and long-term business impact. These metrics, monitored over a six-month post-implementation timeline, will serve as the benchmark for validating the project's success and guiding iterative improvements

Success Metrics (KPIs):

1. 70% of Pilot Team accessing reports
2. Report generation time reduced by 50%
3. Number of manual reporting errors approaches 0

Business Metrics

1. Percentage user training completion
2. Number of active users in the Accounting Department

Business Impact Indicators:

1. Secure and improved access to reports for decision-making
2. Improved decision-making speed
3. Cost savings (in terms of manual hours returned) from manual reporting
4. Reduced operational inefficiencies

Timeline Evaluation

Post Implementation (PI)

Commented [7]: @Afeena, since the trial is 60 days, should we have an evaluation at 60days?

- **30 Days** (*PI*)**:** Pilot feedback and evaluation, minor adjustment tweaks
- **90 Days** (*PI*)**:** Adoption analysis with a review of initial KPI assessment
- **6 Months** (*PI*): Full performance evaluation and business impact assessment

Project Planning Artifact

The Gantt Chart is attached.

References

Coster, M., Danielson, M., Ekenberg, L., Gullberg, C., Titlestad, G., Westelius, A., & Wettergren, G. (2023). *Digital Transformation: Understanding Business Goals, Risks, Processes, and Decisions*. Cambridge: Open Book Publishers. doi:https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0350

Microsoft Fabric Guided Tour. Microsoft Guided Tours. (n.d.). https://guidedtour.microsoft.com/en-us/guidedtour/microsoft-fabric/microsoft-fabric/

What is Microsoft Fabric?. Microsoft Fabric. (n.d.). https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-fabric/resources/data-101/what-is-fabric#interoperability